Alberta Votes on a Big Question About Canada

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Alberta is a **province** in western Canada. On Monday, people there are voting. They are not choosing right now whether to leave Canada. They are choosing whether to hold a special vote about leaving later. That kind of vote is called a **referendum**.

Alberta's leader, Danielle Smith, called the vote after a group gathered about 300,000 names on a **petition**. Another **petition** against leaving got more than 400,000 names. About five million people live in Alberta.

Some people want Alberta to leave. They say Canada's rules about the environment have hurt Alberta's oil-rich **economy**. Others, including Prime Minister Mark Carney, want Alberta to stay. Polls suggest most people there want to stay.

A court said the **petition** to leave did not ask First Nations, **Indigenous** groups whose land would be affected. Smith does not want Alberta to leave, but she says people should have their say.

If voters say yes, a final vote could happen as soon as 2027.

Word Treasure

province -- A province is a big part of a country with its own local leaders, a bit like a U.S. state.

referendum -- A referendum is a vote where people decide a question themselves.

petition -- A petition is a paper that many people sign to ask leaders for something.

economy -- The economy is how a place makes money, jobs and goods.

Indigenous -- Indigenous people are the first people who lived in a place.

Background you need

Canada is the country just north of the United States, and it is split into provinces.

Alberta is one of those provinces, and it has a lot of oil.

In a referendum, people vote on a question directly instead of letting leaders decide.

Break it down

WHO: Voters in Alberta and their leader, Danielle Smith
WHAT: A vote on whether to hold a later referendum about leaving Canada
WHERE: Alberta, a province in western Canada
WHY: Some people say Canada's environment rules hurt Alberta's oil-rich economy, while others want unity

Why it matters

It shows how people in a democracy can vote on big questions about their own future.

Test what you remember

1. Where is Alberta?

- (A) In western Canada
- (B) In Europe
- (C) In Mexico
- (D) In Florida

2. What are people in Alberta voting on Monday?

- (A) What the new flag should look like
- (B) Whether to hold a special vote about leaving Canada later
- (C) Who should be their new mayor
- (D) Whether to build a school

3. About how many names were on the petition to leave?

- (A) About 300,000
- (B) About five million
- (C) Nine
- (D) More than 400,000

4. What do polls suggest most people in Alberta want?

- (A) Not to vote
- (B) To stay in Canada
- (C) To leave right away
- (D) To join the United States

5. Who wants Alberta to stay in Canada?

- (A) Prime Minister Mark Carney
- (B) The petition group
- (C) Only the oil companies
- (D) Nobody

6. When could a final vote happen if voters say yes?

- (A) Last year
- (B) In 100 years
- (C) As soon as 2027
- (D) Tomorrow

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: B 3: A 4: B 5: A 6: C

Questions to think about

1. People who want to leave: They say Canada's environment rules have hurt Alberta's economy.

2. Prime Minister Mark Carney: He wants Alberta to stay part of Canada.

3. Danielle Smith: She does not want Alberta to leave but says people should have their say.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):